



● ELITE PLAN · \$34.99/MONTH

NO EQUIPMENT · 15 TO 30 MIN

10 HIIT ROUTINES

Maximum metabolic stimulus in the minimum time, with the exact structure needed **not** to sacrifice the muscle you have built.

10 COMPLETE ROUTINES

NO EQUIPMENT

8-WEEK PROGRESSION

3 LEVELS



Work and rest

10

ROUTINES

15-30

MINUTES PER
SESSION

3

SCALING LEVELS

9

PAGES

BEFORE THE FIRST ROUND

HIIT is powerful, and that is exactly why it is easy to overdose: done well it burns fat and raises your work capacity; done badly it steals the recovery your lifting depends on.

FIG. 1 INTERVALS AND HEART RATE



The orange blocks are all-out work and the blue ones active rest. Notice that the heart-rate curve **never comes all the way down** between intervals.

THE FIVE RULES OF INTELLIGENT HIIT

01 Never the day before leg day

Nor the day right after. HIIT competes directly with your lower-body session for the same resources.

02 Always warm up for 5 minutes

Hip and ankle mobility, 20 jumping jacks, 10 bodyweight squats and 10 shoulder rotations. It is not optional.

03 The interval is all-out or it is not HIIT

If you can hold a conversation during the work phase, you are doing moderate cardio under a fancier name.

04 Rest is part of the training too

Breathe through your nose and keep walking. Cutting it short does not make the session more effective, only worse executed.

05 Log your rounds and reps

Progressing in HIIT means doing more work in the same time, not simply finishing wrecked.

WHEN NOT TO DO HIIT

- You have slept less than 6 hours, or you are coming off three bad nights in a row.
- You have severe muscle soreness that alters your technique.
- You are in the final week of an aggressive calorie deficit and your strength is dropping.
- You feel joint discomfort in a knee, an ankle, a shoulder or your lower back.

WARNING SIGN: STOP IMMEDIATELY

Chest pain, dizziness, blurred vision, severe nausea or breathlessness out of all proportion to the effort. Stop the session, sit down and seek medical attention if it does not pass within a few minutes.

01 · CLASSIC TABATA — 20 MIN

The most studied HIIT protocol there is. Four blocks of 8 rounds, with 1 minute of rest between blocks.

MEDIUM LEVEL

EXERCISE	WORK	REST	ROUNDS	MAIN MUSCLE
Burpees	20 s	10 s	8	Full body
Star jumps	20 s	10 s	8	Cardio and legs
Mountain climbers	20 s	10 s	8	Core and cardio
Jump squats	20 s	10 s	8	Legs and glutes

02 · HIIT 40/20 — 24 MIN

More time under work to accumulate volume. The best option when the main goal is calorie expenditure.

HIGH LEVEL

EXERCISE	WORK	REST	ROUNDS	MAIN MUSCLE
Sprints in place	40 s	20 s	6	Whole-body cardio
Jump lunges	40 s	20 s	6	Legs
Explosive push-ups	40 s	20 s	6	Chest and triceps
High knees	40 s	20 s	6	Cardio and core

HOW TO RUN THE ROUTINE

In these two routines you complete **every round of one exercise** before moving on to the next. That is what produces the lactate build-up characteristic of the original Tabata.

03 · EMOM — 20 MIN

Every Minute On the Minute: perform the prescribed reps and rest for whatever is left of the minute. The faster you work, the longer you rest. **MEDIUM LEVEL**

BLOCK	WORK PER MINUTE	MINUTES	MAIN MUSCLE
Minutes 1-5	15 burpees	5	Full body
Minutes 6-10	20 jump squats	5	Legs
Minutes 11-15	12 push-ups	5	Upper body
Minutes 16-20	20 mountain climbers	5	Core

04 · FULL BODY FURY — 25 MIN

Full-body circuit: 30 s of work and 15 s of transition, 5 circuits with 1 minute of rest between circuits. **HIGH LEVEL**

EXERCISE	WORK	REST	CIRCUITS	MAIN MUSCLE
Full burpee	30 s	15 s	5	Full body
Jump squat	30 s	15 s	5	Quads and glutes
Push-ups	30 s	15 s	5	Chest and triceps
Alternating lunges	30 s	15 s	5	Legs and glutes
Plank with shoulder tap	30 s	15 s	5	Core and stability

COUNT YOUR REPS ON CIRCUIT 1

Write them down and try to match them on circuit 5. Losing more than 30 % of your reps between the first circuit and the last means you went out too hard: pace yourself better next time.

05 · LOWER BODY INFERNO — 22 MIN

40 s of work and 20 s of rest, 4 circuits. Specific lower-body work: place it well away from your leg day. **HIGH LEVEL**

EXERCISE	WORK	REST	CIRCUITS	MAIN MUSCLE
Box or step jump	40 s	20 s	4	Quad power
Sumo squat	40 s	20 s	4	Adductors and glutes
Wall sit	40 s	20 s	4	Quads (isometric)
Alternating Bulgarian split squat	40 s	20 s	4	Single-leg glute
Calf raises with a hop	40 s	20 s	4	Gastrocnemius and soleus

06 · UPPER BODY BLAST — 20 MIN

35 s of work and 15 s of rest, 5 circuits. Ideal as a finisher after a light upper-body session. **MEDIUM LEVEL**

EXERCISE	WORK	REST	CIRCUITS	MAIN MUSCLE
Standard push-ups	35 s	15 s	5	Chest
Dips on a bench or chair	35 s	15 s	5	Triceps
Diamond push-ups	35 s	15 s	5	Triceps and inner chest
Pike push-ups	35 s	15 s	5	Shoulder

SCALING THE PUSH-UPS

If you cannot complete 8 clean reps, drop to your knees or raise your hands onto a bench. Lowering the demand while keeping the full range is always better than half-reps with a sagging hip.

07 · CORE DESTROYER — 18 MIN

30 s of work and 10 s of rest, 6 circuits. The shortest routine, and the one that pairs best with any other.

MEDIUM LEVEL

EXERCISE	WORK	REST	CIRCUITS	MAIN MUSCLE
Front plank	30 s	10 s	6	Anterior core
Russian twists	30 s	10 s	6	Obliques
Bicycle crunches	30 s	10 s	6	Rectus abdominis and obliques
V-sit	30 s	10 s	6	Full core

08 · CARDIO KING — 30 MIN

45 s of work and 15 s of rest, 4 circuits with 1 minute between circuits. The highest calorie-burn session in this document.

HIGH LEVEL

EXERCISE	WORK	REST	CIRCUITS	MAIN MUSCLE
Sprint in place	45 s	15 s	4	Whole-body cardio
Jump rope, or the same movement without a rope	45 s	15 s	4	Calves and coordination
High knees	45 s	15 s	4	Hip flexors
Lateral skaters	45 s	15 s	4	Gluteus medius
Burpee without the push-up	45 s	15 s	4	Full body
Jumping jacks	45 s	15 s	4	Cardio

CARDIO KING IS NOT A WEEKLY ROUTINE

Use it **once every two weeks** at most. Thirty minutes at this intensity create a central fatigue you will feel in the gym for two days.

09 · METABOLIC CIRCUIT — 28 MIN

Five 4-minute AMRAP blocks (as many rounds as possible), with 2 minutes of rest between blocks.

ADVANCED LEVEL

BLOCK	SEQUENCE (REPEAT FOR 4 MIN)	ROUNDS COMPLETED
Block 1	8 burpees + 12 jump squats	
Block 2	10 push-ups + 15 mountain climbers per side	
Block 3	12 alternating lunges + 10 box jumps	
Block 4	15 jumping jacks + 10 V-sits + 20 s of plank	
Block 5	8 burpees + 8 diamond push-ups + 20 high knees	

10 · FINISHER EXPRESS — 15 MIN

Eight exercises in Tabata format (20 s / 10 s), three full circuits with 1 minute between circuits. The workout you never feel like doing.

MAXIMUM LEVEL

ORDER	EXERCISE	ORDER	EXERCISE
1	Burpees	5	Jump lunges
2	Jump squats	6	Russian twists
3	Push-ups	7	Lateral skaters
4	Mountain climbers	8	Active plank

HOW TO SCORE YOUR SESSION

In AMRAP routines your score is the **total number of rounds**. Write it down and compare it every four weeks on the same routine: it is the cleanest way to confirm that your conditioning really is improving.

8-WEEK PROGRESSION

WEEK	SESSIONS	RECOMMENDED ROUTINES	TARGET
Week 1	2	07 Core Destroyer · 03 EMOM	Learn the formats without wrecking yourself
Week 2	2	01 Tabata · 06 Upper Body Blast	Introduce pure interval work
Week 3	3	01 Tabata · 04 Full Body Fury · 07 Core	Raise the frequency
Week 4	2	03 EMOM · 07 Core Destroyer	Deload: less volume, same intensity
Week 5	3	02 HIIT 40/20 · 05 Lower Inferno · 06 Upper	Work by specific muscle groups
Week 6	3	02 HIIT 40/20 · 04 Full Body Fury · 08 Cardio King	Highest calorie burn of the block
Week 7	4	09 Metabolic · 05 Lower · 06 Upper · 07 Core	Volume peak
Week 8	3	10 Finisher Express · 01 Tabata · 07 Core	Final test and deload

SCALING TO YOUR LEVEL

VARIABLE	BEGINNER	INTERMEDIATE	ADVANCED
Work/rest ratio	20 s / 40 s	30 s / 30 s	40 s / 20 s
Circuits	Half of those prescribed	As prescribed	As prescribed + 1
Burpees	No jump, no push-up	Full	With a knees-to-chest jump
Push-ups	On your knees	Standard	Explosive, or with a clap
Jump squat	Bodyweight squat	With a jump	With a jump and a 180° turn
Joint impact	Replace the jumps with steps	Controlled jump	Full plyometric jump

YOUR SESSION LOG

DATE	ROUTINE	ROUNDS OR REPS	RPE (1-10)	HOW IT FELT

WHERE EVERY NUMBER COMES FROM

Every number in this document comes from sources that are public, free and checkable. Not one figure is invented, rounded for convenience or copied from another popular publication. This page exists so that you can verify it yourself.

WHY THESE SOURCES AND NO OTHERS

Works of the United States federal government are not subject to copyright (17 U.S.C. § 105). That makes a handful of agencies the only source of nutrition and training data that is both first-rate and legally free. This is not restricted material: it is public material that almost nobody opens.

WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING FOR	WHAT YOU WILL FIND	WHERE
Reference intakes	RDA, AI and tolerable upper intake level for every vitamin and mineral	ods.od.nih.gov
Food composition	The full profile of any food, nutrient by nutrient	fdc.nal.usda.gov
Dietary guidelines	Dietary patterns and limits for added sugars, saturated fat and sodium	health.gov
Physical activity guidelines	The weekly dose, its response curve and the strength requirement	health.gov
Physical readiness doctrine	FM 7-22: training, nutrition, sleep and mental readiness	armypubs.army.mil
Lifting equation	How much weight is reasonable to lift in each specific situation	cdc.gov/niosh
Food safety	Safe internal temperatures and the danger zone	foodsafety.gov
Health claims	What may legally be claimed about a nutrient in Europe, and what was refused	European Commission register

HOW THIS DOCUMENT CHECKS ITSELF

The reference figures are not typed by hand: they live in a data module that the typesetting program verifies before writing a single line. It checks that the macronutrient ranges can add up to one hundred per cent of energy, that none of the 19 micronutrients has a recommended value above its own ceiling without a note explaining why, and that no safe cooking temperature falls inside the danger zone. If a single check fails, the document is not typeset.

REFERENCE VALUES ARE POPULATION VALUES

They describe what covers the needs of most healthy adults. They are not an individual prescription, they do not account for disease, pregnancy, breastfeeding or medication, and no publication replaces assessment by a registered health professional. If you take medication, some of the nutrients named here interact with it in clinically relevant ways: do not change an intake or start a supplement without telling whoever prescribes for you.

TECHNIQUE FOR THE KEY MOVEMENTS

EXERCISE	CORRECT EXECUTION	THE MISTAKE THAT CAUSES INJURY
Burpee	Hands to the floor, controlled jump back, chest down, jump forward and vertical jump	Letting the hip drop on the way down (lumbar hyperextension)
Jump squat	Land on the ball of the foot first and absorb by bending knee and hip	Landing with a stiff leg and the knee caving inwards
Mountain climbers	Hip low and stable, shoulders over the wrists	Raising the hip and bouncing off the feet
Jump lunge	Torso vertical, rear knee towards the floor without touching it	Front knee travelling far beyond the toes
Push-up	Body in a straight line, elbows at 45°, chest to the floor	Elbows flared to 90° and hip sagging
Plank	Glutes and abs engaged, hip neutral, eyes on the floor	Hip too high or sagging, neck in extension
Box jump	Jump up, step down	Jumping back down: it multiplies the load on the patellar tendon

TECHNIQUE BREAKS BEFORE THE MUSCLE DOES

In the last 10 seconds of every interval, fatigue degrades execution. If you feel your position going, **stop and end the interval**. A badly done burpee does not add work, it adds risk.

HIIT IS ONLY ONE PIECE

HIIT pays off when it is **not the only thing you do**: two sessions a week at most, never on consecutive days, and always on a base of strength work, enough food and sleep. On its own it turns into wear and tear.

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